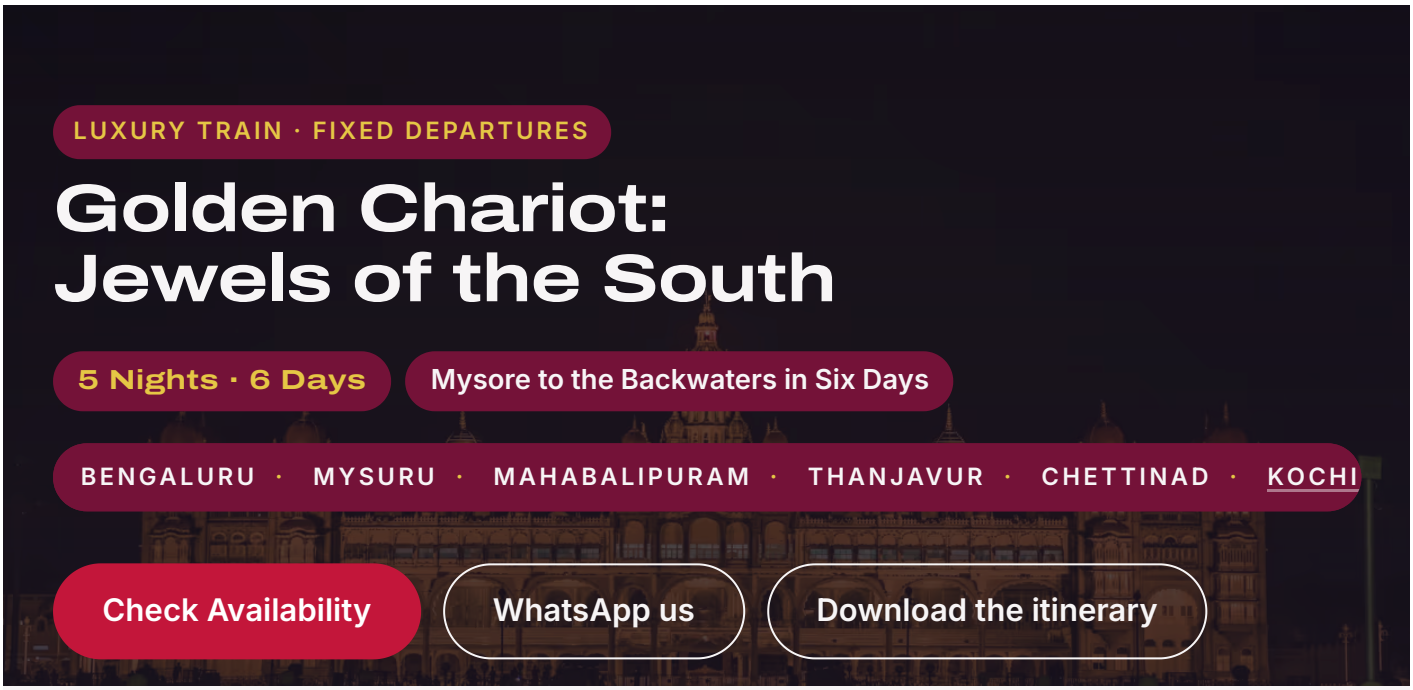
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https://india-visit-website.pages.dev/journeys/golden-chariot-5n-6d/



DURATION
5 Nights · 6 Days

ROUTE
Bengaluru return

PACE
Moderate

BEST SEASON
October to March

IDEAL FOR
Couples, Seniors, First-Timers

The Golden Chariot is South India's luxury train, and Jewels of the South is its loop through two states and three thousand years of building: the Wadiyar palace at Mysore, the Pallava shore temples at Mahabalipuram, the Chola summit at Thanjavur, the merchant mansions of Chettinad, and then over the Ghats to Kochi and the backwaters. Six days, one unpacking, and the distances covered while you sleep.

The operator runs the train, and we handle everything around it: the booking form, the cabin, the questions you will have about what a day on board actually looks like, and the person who meets you at Bengaluru.

Journey Highlights

- **Board** South India's luxury train at Bengaluru and unpack once for a six-day loop through two states and three thousand years of building.
- **Begin** at Mysore Palace, the Amba Vilas, seat of the Wadiyar dynasty and one of the most visited buildings in India.
- **Walk** the seventh-century shore temples of Mahabalipuram, carved by the Pallavas on a strip of land between the Bay of Bengal and a salt lake.
- **Stand** inside the Brihadeeswara Temple at Thanjavur, a UNESCO World Heritage Site and the summit of Chola architecture.
- **Visit** the tile works and the merchant mansions of Chettinad, built by a trading community that furnished them from across the world.
- **Watch** Kerala's classical dance in Fort Kochi after the Dutch Palace at Mattancherry, and end with a houseboat cruise on the backwaters at Cherthala.

Cabin Categories

> Operated by IRCTC, the Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation. Operator terms apply to your journey. Booking terms

TOP TIER

Deluxe Cabin

> Double or twin-bedded cabin with an en suite bathroom
>
> Butler service

Off-train excursions by Volvo coach or tempo traveller with a shared English-speaking guide

Enquire for pricing

Itinerary at a Glance

DAY	DESTINATION	SIGNATURE EXPERIENCE
Day 01	**Bengaluru to Mysuru**	Registration, boarding and Mysore Palace
Day 02	**Mahabalipuram**	Optional Kanchipuram; the Pallava shore temples
Day 03	**Thanjavur and Chettinad**	Brihadeeswara Temple, then the Chettinad mansions
Day 04	**Kochi**	Mattancherry Palace and a Kerala dance performance
Day 05	**Cherthala**	A houseboat cruise on the backwaters
Day 06	**Bengaluru**	Breakfast aboard; the journey ends at Bengaluru City

Day by Day

Expand all

Day 01 Bengaluru to Mysuru: Boarding and the Palace

Train · Departs Yeshwanthpur, Bengaluru

Arrive at Yeshwanthpur station in Bengaluru in the morning for a welcome and registration, and the train departs at half past ten. Lunch is served on board as it runs south-west to Mysuru. In the afternoon, Mysore Palace: the Amba Vilas, a historical palace and royal residence, seat of the Wadiyar dynasty and the Kingdom of Mysore, and one of the most visited buildings in the country. Back to the train for dinner as it moves on overnight towards Chengalpattu.

Overnight aboard

Day 02 Mahabalipuram: The Pallava Shore

Train · Overnight to Chengalpattu

A relaxed breakfast on board as the train arrives at Chengalpattu. The forenoon is an optional excursion to Kanchipuram, the temple city, before lunch at a beachfront hotel. Then Mahabalipuram, on a strip of land between the Bay of Bengal and the Great Salt Lake, known for the temples and monuments the Pallava dynasty carved and built here in the seventh and eighth centuries. Dinner on the train as it heads for Thanjavur.

Overnight aboard

Day 03 Thanjavur and Chettinad: Chola Stone, Merchant Mansions

Train · Overnight to Kochi

The Brihadeeswara Temple, called Rajarajesvaram by the Chola king who built it and Periya Kovil (the big temple) by the town: a UNESCO World Heritage Site on the south bank of the Cauvery, and the high point of the Chola style. Lunch is served on board as the train moves to Chettinad, where the afternoon takes in the Athangudi tile works and the mansions of the Chettiar merchant community. Dinner aboard as the train crosses to Kerala overnight.

Overnight aboard

Day 04 Kochi: The Dutch Palace and a Dance

After breakfast on board, the Mattancherry Palace in Fort Kochi (popularly the Dutch Palace, built by the Portuguese and renovated by the Dutch), followed by a performance of Kerala's classical dance forms at an exclusive venue. Back to the train for lunch, and an India evening on board with dinner.

Explore Kochi →

Overnight aboard

Day 05 Cherthala: The Backwaters by Houseboat

Boat · Houseboat cruise on the backwaters

Cherthala sits twenty kilometres north of Alappuzha, a satellite of Kochi on the edge of the backwaters. Breakfast is served on board, and the day is a houseboat cruise through the canals and lagoons, with lunch at an exclusive venue on the water. Return to the train in the evening for dinner as it begins the run back to Karnataka.

Overnight aboard

Day 06 Bengaluru: The Journey Ends

Train · Overnight to Bengaluru City

Breakfast is served on board as the train arrives at KSR Bengaluru City station, and the journey ends with disembarkation at half past nine. We can arrange your onward transfer, a night in Bengaluru, or a day's sightseeing in the city before your flight.

Departure

What's included

- Accommodation in double or twin-bedded cabins with en suite bathrooms
- All meals, soft beverages, and house brands of Indian wines, beer and spirits
- Butler service
- Guided off-train excursions as set out in the itinerary, including entrance fees, still-camera fees, transport and the services of a guide
- Complimentary tea, coffee and packaged drinking water on board
- Porterage at stations
- The services of a paramedic on board

Not included

- Optional tours mentioned in the itinerary
- Insurance and gratuities
- Telephone calls, laundry, and alcoholic beverages beyond the house brands served in the restaurants, bar and on excursions
- Video, film and professional still-camera fees
- Arrival and departure transfers
- International and domestic air tickets
- Pre- and post-tour accommodation and any extensions, unless specifically named as part of the journey

2026–27 SEASON

Departures

Seasonal departures: enquire for current dates. The Golden Chariot runs a fixed-departure schedule set by the operator and revised each season, so we confirm live availability for your dates rather than publish a timetable that could go stale. A seasonal supplement applies to departures over Christmas and New Year and to the operator's Signature journeys; we quote it with the fare.

How booking works

01

Select and finalise the journey

We confirm your departure and cabin, then share the booking form together with the cancellation terms. Passport copies are needed to record each traveller's name, nationality and passport number.

02

Pay the advance

An advance of 30% against the invoice secures the booking. If your international flights are already arranged, share the details at this stage.

03

Receive written confirmation

Once the advance is received you get a confirmation email and letter, along with a breakdown of the amount received and the balance due.

04

Adjust the details

Tell us about anything you would like added or changed and we will check what is possible with the operator. Some changes cannot be accommodated on a fixed-departure train.

05

Clear the balance 95 days before arrival

The balance must be cleared at least 95 days before arrival in India. We send a receipt once it is in.

06

Arrival assistance

About a week before departure we share your arrival assistance details: who will meet you at the airport and the name of your assigned guest relations manager.

Practical notes

Visa

Foreign passport holders need a valid Indian visa before boarding their flight to India.

Getting there

The journey begins and ends in Bengaluru; Kempegowda International (BLR) is the arrival point. We can add a night and a city tour in Bengaluru either side.

Season

The train runs a seasonal schedule through the cooler months. We confirm current departure dates on enquiry.

Pace

Moderate. You unpack once and the train moves overnight, with a full excursion most days and lunch on board or at a venue en route.

Policies & cancellation

Operated by IRCTC, the Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation. Operator terms apply to your journey.
Operated by IRCTC (Indian Railway Catering and Tourism Corporation). Full booking terms

Cancellation charges

Cancellation requests must be made in writing and acknowledged by us. If we are informed 80 days or more before departure, 35% of the published ticket tariff is non-refundable; between 65 and 79 days before departure, 60%; and 64 days or fewer before departure, 100%.

No-shows and journeys ended early

If a guest does not appear at the departure point, no refund or adjustment is made. If the journey is ended by the guest, the unused portion is not refunded or reused. In the case of a no-

show through serious illness, the operator decides whether an alternative itinerary or date can be offered; no refund is made, and no such amendment is possible on a whole-train or charter booking.

Children

Children under five travel free when sharing a bed with a parent, where a double-bed cabin is available. Children between five and twelve are charged half the adult fare and must travel with two adults; in a separate cabin, children are charged half the adult fare plus any supplement. We will set out the arrangement that fits your family before you book.

Amendments and date changes

Amendments are subject to the operator's approval and are generally considered only in circumstances such as natural disaster or serious illness supported by a doctor's certificate. A request to postpone the same passengers to a future date carries a per-person charge and is subject to the operator's approval; changes to travel dates or passenger names are otherwise governed by the cancellation rules above.

If the operator cancels a departure

If a scheduled departure does not operate, you will be informed at least one week beforehand, and the full amount received is refunded, credited against future travel, or held as a credit note, without any cancellation fee. We cannot compensate for consequential costs such as air tickets or hotel bookings made independently.

Visas and travel documents

All foreign passport holders require a valid Indian visa before boarding a flight to India. Requests for refunds arising from visa refusal, or from arriving without the correct travel documents, are governed by the cancellation rules above.

Operator's right to amend

The train operator reserves the right to amend the itinerary, fees and cancellation or refund rules, and because the train runs on Indian Railways track, the routing is subject to change. Scheduled excursions cancelled by the tour manager at short notice for local reasons are not refundable. Any resulting difference or additional charge is payable by the guest as per the operator's rules.